STATE OF ALASKA
REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS

ELIGIBILITY & ENROLLMENT MODERNIZATION MILESTONE 2.5 - DATA ARCHITECTURE, INTEROPERABILITY, AND REPORTING

RFP 2026-1600-0141

ISSUED JANUARY 22, 2026

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THE ALASKA DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH (DOH) IS SOLICITING PROPOSALS FOR QUALIFIED CONTRACTORS TO SUPPORT THE CONTINUING MODERNIZATION DEVELOPMENT OF THE PUBLIC ASSISTANCE INTEGRATED ELIGIBILITY PLATFORM.

ISSUED BY:

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OFFERORS ARE NOT REQUIRED TO RETURN THIS FORM

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SECTION 1. INTRODUCTION & INSTRUCTIONS

SEC. 1.01 PURPOSE OF THE RFP

The Division of Public Assistance (DPA), through its Eligibility Modernization Project Management Office (EMO), is soliciting proposals from qualified contractors to design, develop, and implement a modern data integration and operational platform that supports the modernization of the Integrated Eligibility System (IEP). The proposed solution must be able to ingest and migrate data from multiple enterprise systems into a modern, integrated operational data repository accessible to all authorized consumers.

The successful offeror will be expected to deliver:

- **Discovery and Analysis** – Assess available options and develop actionable recommendations.
- **Design and Architecture** – Develop a modern data platform and associated microservices structure aligned with DPA's modernization roadmap.
- **Data Integration** – Consolidate data from multiple sources into a single integrated repository.
- **Service Integration** – Implement API Gateway services to support eligibility determination and benefit administration.

DPA Eligibility & Enrollment Modernization Roadmap

The State of Alaska, in partnership with federal agencies and stakeholders, is advancing a continuously updated roadmap toward a fully Integrated Eligibility Platform (IEP). The IEP is designed to support a full range of administrative services, including eligibility determination and benefit administration for all Division of Public Assistance (DPA) programs.

This roadmap provides a holistic and hierarchical view of the Eligibility & Enrollment (E&E) Modernization initiatives. It establishes clear prioritization, scope, and goals, while serving as a communication tool for stakeholders. The roadmap is structured around **five (5) key milestones** that collectively advance DPA's transition from the legacy mainframe system.

- **Alaska Product Roadmap:** View here
- **Mission Model Canvas:** View here

The roadmap outlines a **modular strategy** that emphasizes agile product development and DevSecOps practices. This approach enables continuous, measurable, and sustainable improvements as programs migrate from the legacy Eligibility Information System (EIS) to the modern IEP.

Note: Offerors who responded to RFP 2025-1600-0188 (Milestone 2) are eligible to respond to this RFP, as well as future solicitations.

More detailed information can be found in SEC. 3 SCOPE OF WORK & CONTRACTUAL INFORMATION.

SEC. 1.02 BUDGET

The Department of Health (DOH), Division of Public Assistance (DPA), estimates a budget of $5,000,000.00 for the completion of this project. Proposals priced at more than $5,000,000.00 will be considered non-responsive.

Approval or continuation of a contract resulting from this RFP is contingent upon legislative appropriation and/or federal funding.

SEC. 1.03 DEADLINE FOR RECEIPT OF PROPOSALS

Proposals must be received no later than **12:00 PM prevailing Alaska Time** on **April 20, 2026**. Late proposals or amendments will be disqualified and not opened or accepted for evaluation.

SEC. 1.04 MANDATORY REQUIREMENTS

To be considered responsive for this RFP, an offeror must meet the mandatory minimum experience requirements that are provided in Submittal Form E. Failure to meet all these requirements will result in immediate disqualification.

SEC. 1.05 REQUIRED REVIEW

Offerors should carefully review this solicitation for defects and questionable or objectionable material. Comments concerning defects and questionable or objectionable material should be made in writing and received by the procurement officer at least ten days before the deadline for receipt of proposals. This allows time to issue any necessary amendments.

SEC. 1.06 QUESTIONS PRIOR TO DEADLINE FOR RECEIPT OF PROPOSALS

Questions or comments regarding this RFP shall be submitted as issues within this RFP's GitHub repository no later than **4:00 PM Alaska Standard Time on March 13th, 2026,** to allow the State sufficient time to respond. All questions and comments will be publicly available. Please add yourself as a watcher on the Milestone 2.5 RFP GitHub Repository if your firm would like updates about changes and comments. Questions or comments received after the required deadline may not be answered. All questions must be in writing and directed to the procurement officer at least ten days before the deadline for receipt of proposals.

Two types of questions generally arise; responses are posted to the project GitHub site:

- Inquiries or clarifications that can be addressed in a succinct written response on the project GitHub site or by directing the questioner to a specific section of the RFP
- Other questions may be more complex and may require a written amendment to the RFP. The procurement officer will make that decision

SEC. 1.07 RETURN INSTRUCTIONS

Offerors must submit their proposals via email. The technical proposal and cost proposal must be saved as separate documents and emailed to doh.procurement.proposals@alaska.gov as separate, clearly labeled attachments. The email must contain the RFP number in the subject line. The maximum size of a single email (including all text and attachments) that can be received by the state is 25mb (megabytes). If the email containing the proposal exceeds this size, the proposal must be sent in multiple emails that are each less than 25 megabytes. Please note that email transmission is not instantaneous. When emailing your proposal, the state recommends sending it ahead of time to ensure the email is delivered by the deadline for receipt of proposals. It is the offeror's responsibility to contact the above email address to confirm that the proposal has been received. The state is not responsible for unreadable, corrupt, or missing attachments.

SEC. 1.08 ASSISTANCE TO OFFERORS WITH DISABILITY

Offerors with a disability may receive accommodation regarding the means of communicating this RFP or participating in the procurement process. For more information, contact the procurement officer no later than ten days prior to the deadline for receipt of proposals.

SEC. 1.09 AMENDMENTS TO PROPOSALS

Amendments to or withdrawals of proposals will only be allowed if acceptable requests are received prior to the deadline specified for receipt of proposals (refer to section 1.03). No amendments or withdrawals will be accepted after the deadline unless they are in response to the state's request in accordance with 2 AAC 12.290.

SEC. 1.10 AMENDMENTS TO THE RFP

If an amendment is issued before the deadline for receipt of proposals, it will be provided to all who were notified of the RFP and to those who have registered with the procurement officer after receiving the RFP from the State of Alaska Online Public Notice website.

After receipt of proposals, if there is a need for any substantial clarification or material change in the RFP, an amendment will be issued. The amendment will incorporate the clarification or change, and a new date and time established for new or amended proposals. Evaluations may be adjusted as a result of receiving new or amended proposals.

SEC. 1.11 RFP SCHEDULE

RFP schedule set out herein represents the state’s best estimate of the schedule that will be followed. If a component of this schedule, such as the deadline for receipt of proposals, is delayed, the rest of the schedule may be shifted accordingly. All times are Alaska Time.

ACTIVITY	TIME	DATE
Issue Date / RFP Released		January 22, 2026
Deadline to Submit Questions	4:00 PM	March 13, 2026
Deadline for Receipt of Proposals / Proposal Due Date	12:00 PM	April 20, 2026
Proposal Evaluation Start		Week of April 20, 2026
Interviews Complete		May 18, 2026
Notice of Intent to Award		Week of May 18, 2026,
Request for CMS Approval Sent		Week of May 18, 2026
Contract Issued for Review and Signature		July 2026
Contract Start Date		July 2026

This RFP does not, by itself, obligate the state. The state's obligation commences when the contract is approved by the Commissioner of the Department of Health, or the Commissioner's designee. Upon written notice to the contractor, the state may set a different starting date for the contract. The state is not responsible for any work done by the contractor, even work done in good faith, if it occurs prior to the contract start date set by the state.

SEC. 1.12 PRE-PROPOSAL CONFERENCE

A pre-proposal conference/teleconference will not be held for this solicitation. Interested parties may submit questions in writing per SEC. 1.06 Questions Prior to Deadline for Receipt of Proposal.

SEC. 1.13 ALTERNATE PROPOSALS

Offerors may only submit one proposal for evaluation. In accordance with 2 AAC 12.830 alternate proposals (proposals that offer something different than what is asked for) will be rejected.

SEC. 1.14 NEWS RELEASES

News releases related to this RFP will not be made without prior approval of the project director.

SECTION 2. BACKGROUND INFORMATION

Alaska Statute 47.05.010 designates the Department of Health (DOH), Division of Public Assistance (DPA), as the agency responsible for determining eligibility and administering Alaska's public assistance programs. Under this authority, DPA is charged with making determinations in accordance with state and federal regulations, as outlined in Alaska Administrative Code, Title 7.

The Division's mission is to "promote self-sufficiency and provide basic living expenses to Alaskans in need."

Alaska's public assistance programs:

- Adult Public Assistance (APA)
- Alaska Temporary Assistance Program (ATAP)
- ATAP Work Services
- Childcare
- Family Nutrition
- General Relief Assistance
- Heating Assistance
- Interim Assistance
- Medicaid
    - Modified Adjusted Gross Income (MAGI)
    - Denali KidCare (DKC)
    - Aged, Disabled, Blind, and Long-Term Care
- Permanent Fund Dividend Hold-Harmless
- Senior Benefits
- Supplement Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) (aka food stamps)
- SNAP Employment and Training
- Tribal Assistance for Needy Families (TANF)
- Women, Infants, and Children Program (WIC)

The Division of Public Assistance (DPA) works closely with federal partners—including the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS), the Food and Nutrition Service (FNS), and the Administration for Children and Families (ACF)—to implement federal regulations and program requirements.

To fulfill these responsibilities, DPA relies on several technical systems:

- **Eligibility Information System (EIS):** A legacy mainframe system supporting eligibility determination and benefit administration for multiple public assistance programs.

- **Alaska's Resource for Integrated Eligibility Services (ARIES):** A modern system supporting Modified Adjusted Gross Income (MAGI) Medicaid eligibility and administration. ARIES is a core component of Alaska's Integrated Eligibility Platform (IEP) and provides the foundation for expanding modernized eligibility services across all public assistance programs.

Eligibility Information System (EIS)

While EIS has effectively supported program administration and benefit delivery for over 40 years, the technology on which it is based (IBM mainframe platform, COBOL software development language and ADABAS database management system) is becoming increasingly difficult and costly to maintain. Many significant changes in public

assistance programs and program administration have occurred since the system was placed into production in 1984. Mandatory federal Medicaid provisions of the ACA, Welfare Reform, new program demands, and the continued growth and complexity in public assistance programs are creating a shift in business needs. The system is currently functioning well beyond the capacity for which it was designed and does not provide the flexibility needed to implement mandatory federal provisions.

A key objective for the State of Alaska is to de-commission the EIS system as soon as possible; DPA has developed an Eligibility Modernization Roadmap to plan for and support this objective.

Alaska's Resource for Integrated Eligibility Services (ARIES)

Alaska's Resource for Integrated Eligibility Services (ARIES) is hosted in the Azure Commercial Cloud and built on a modern, scalable framework. Originally implemented to support eligibility determination and benefit administration for MAGI Medicaid, ARIES now serves as the cornerstone of Alaska's Integrated Eligibility Platform (IEP).

The system is actively used by more than 400 Division of Public Assistance (DPA) staff, including eligibility technicians, administrative personnel, and management. In addition, ARIES supports access for multiple contractors and community partners who assist with public assistance program administration. Altogether, the system supports over 700 users and manages eligibility and benefits for more than 200,000 recipients.

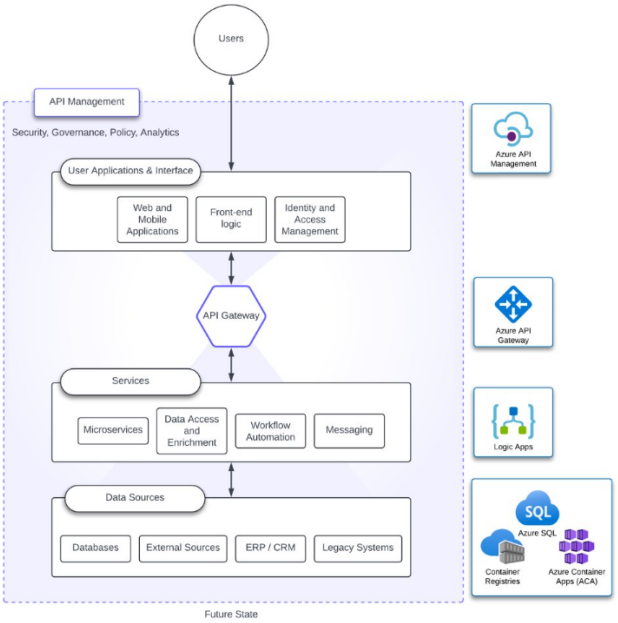
DPA is currently working to de-couple and extend ARIES through the use of microservices, enabling the platform to support eligibility determination and benefit administration for additional public assistance programs, including the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP).

Integrated Eligibility Platform (IEP)

DPA is developing a modern, Integrated Eligibility Platform (IEP) that enables staff to more efficiently issue correct and timely benefits to Alaskans who need help meeting their basic needs. While the IEP encompasses several systems, each with a specific purpose, the ARIES system is the cornerstone. DPA intends to leverage and extend the ARIES system to develop a fully Integrated Eligibility Platform (IEP), that supports eligibility determination and benefit administration for all public assistance programs, as well as integration/interoperability across the systems within the integrated eligibility platform.

Integrated Eligibility Platform (IEP) Architecture

- **API Management (APIM)**
  - Creation, publication, maintenance, monitoring, and security of the API ecosystem
  - Includes the API gateway and developer portal
- **API Three Layer Architecture**
  - Layer 1: User Applications and Interface
    - Seamless experience for users
    - Built using front-end technologies such as JavaScript
  - Layer 2: Services
    - Provides business logic services, such as workflow automation and data transformation in both directions
  - Layer 3: Data Sources
    - In a modern organization, the sources of data can be many, including databases and CRM systems



Utilizing agile development methods and modular procurements, DPA has the goal of implementing an eligibility system that not only meets state and federal standards, but is user friendly for clients, eligibility staff, and technical staff.

DPA has moved away from a "big bang" waterfall acquisitions process to a more modular approach, emphasizing user centered design, agile product development, and DevSecOps practices. We integrate user experience, security, and privacy into all our development work. More information about the Alaska E&E Modernization project can be found in this repository **(be sure to add yourself as a watcher on the overall eligibility modernization repository to automatically get updates about changes and upcoming procurements)**. The goal of this approach is twofold:

- Persistently deliver measurable and sustainable incremental improvements to the IEP
- Migrate the remaining public assistance programs off the legacy EIS mainframe system and onto the new Integrated Eligibility platform (ARIES/IEP)

Offerors should review this repository for information that will be critical in constructing a quality proposal. Of specific interest are:

- Procurement strategy
- Modular product design strategy and our Modular Experience and API Framework Prototype
- How We Work
- EIS Modernization Project Technical Strategy

To ensure ongoing progress towards meeting DPA roadmap goals, this approach involves organizing product teams to focus on individual procurements and product increments. These teams work together with the selected vendor to complete work organized by regular sprints. These sprints encompass activities such as daily or regular standups, end-of-sprint retrospectives, sprint reviews of completed work, sprint planning, and backlog grooming sessions.

Our Eligibility Modernization Roadmap – Milestones – found here map out DPA migration strategy to move the remaining programs out of the EIS mainframe system and into a modern modular software and platform with architecture based on open Application Programming Interface (API) data standardization. Each Milestone is a separate procurement/project.

The first product increments were improvements to the worker experience in the ARIES system, in addition to stabilizing the underlying infrastructure; this was Milestone 1 on our modernization roadmap.

Milestone 2, Increments 1-5 of our modernization roadmap, we will be developing the product features needed to support eligibility determination and benefit administration for the remaining non-MAGI Medicaid categories and hospital presumptive eligibility. This procurement/acquisition is complete; the project began in October 2025. Specific information regarding this procurement can be found in the RFP-IES-Milestone2 GitHub Repo **(make sure to add yourself as a watcher to receive updates)**.

This Request for Proposal (RFP) is seeking a vendor to develop and support the efforts within Milestone 2.5 on the modernization roadmap. The objective of Milestone 2.5 is to migrate and convert the mainframe data and reports that are associated with Milestones 2 and 3, into a modern data repository that is accessible via API to all consumers. Specifically, this project will migrate and convert beneficiary data, and related operational and administrative reports for the non-MAGI Medicaid programs and Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP).; Additional information is provided in Sec. 3.01 Scope of Work.

SEC. 2.01 PROGRAM INFORMATION

As stated above, the Department of Health (DOH) is the state agency designated to administer the Alaska Medicaid and SNAP programs, which include:

- Medicaid
- Denali KidCare
- Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP)

The Division of Public Assistance (DPA) is responsible for determining the eligibility of individuals and families in need of Medicaid benefits.

DPA administers the Medicaid program in accordance with Federal and State laws and regulations. The Medicaid program is authorized under Title XIX and Title XXI of the Social Security Act and the Code of Federal Regulations, Title 42 Part 435 and Title 45 Part 233. Alaska's Medicaid State Plan may be viewed here.

Alaska joined the Medicaid program in September 1972. The state Legislature has added new services and eligible groups to the Medicaid program since that time. The Medicaid program in Alaska is authorized under Alaska Statutes 47.07.010 - 47.07.900 and the Alaska Administrative Code, Title 7 Chapter 43 and Chapter 100.

Additional program details are provided in Attachment 09.

SEC. 2.02 OUTCOMES AND MEASURES

CMS-required outcomes for Medicaid Enterprise Systems (MES) are the standard requirements for certification based on federal regulations and statutes. These outcomes establish a baseline for the functionality of a system or module, which is required to continue receiving federal funding for operations. CMS-required outcomes also demonstrate that a system complies with applicable federal regulations. For supporting detail on specific CMS Outcomes, please refer to Attachment 08.

While the CMS Required Outcomes are not within the direct scope of this RFP, the contractor must ensure the metric data DPA uses to measure these required outcomes remains intact (or alternate metrics are defined based upon the converted/migrated data).

State Based Outcomes

- **Modernized Data Infrastructure:** The legacy Eligibility Information System (EIS) data will be successfully migrated to a secure, cloud-based data repository in Microsoft Azure, enabling real-time access and interoperability with existing systems, especially with the new Integrated Eligibility Platform (IEP) for all public assistance programs
- **Improved Eligibility Determination and Benefit Administration:** The new data integration solution will support accurate and timely eligibility determinations and benefit issuance for non-MAGI Medicaid and SNAP programs, in compliance with federal and state regulations
- **Enhanced Reporting and Analytics Capabilities:** A separate, but integrated data lake/warehouse will be implemented to support advanced analytics, business intelligence, and secure, role-based access. This analytics system will be built in Azure and utilize industry standard data modeling methodologies appropriate for the system's purpose, improving operational oversight and decision-making.
- **Compliance with Federal Certification Standards:** The solution will meet all CMS-required outcomes and security standards (including MARS-E 2.2 and ARC-AMPE Framework), ensuring continued federal funding and authorization to operate
- **Sustainable Agile Development and Documentation:** The project will follow agile development practices with continuous delivery, automated documentation, and modular design, ensuring maintainability, scalability, and ease of future integration
- **Data Integrity:** The contractor will ensure that all migrated data from the legacy Eligibility Information System (EIS) to the modern cloud-based repository maintains high standards of quality, integrity, and usability. This includes validating data extraction, transformation, and loading (ETL) processes; confirming data completeness and accuracy; and implementing robust data governance practices. The resulting data must be accessible for reporting, auditing, and operational use, supporting secure, role-based access and enabling informed decision-making across all public assistance programs
- **Scalability and Unified Architecture:** The contractor will design and implement both the operational data system and the reporting data system using a unified set of tools, technologies, and frameworks, preferably leveraging open standards and extensible architectures within Azure. This approach will ensure that the Alaska Department of Health can independently scale, maintain, and enhance the solution without ongoing vendor dependency. The architecture must support modularity, reusability, and internal capacity building through comprehensive documentation and knowledge transfer
- **Comprehensive Documentation, Training, and Knowledge Transfer:** The contractor will provide extensive, user-friendly documentation covering system architecture, data workflows, configuration, and maintenance procedures. In addition, the contractor will deliver structured training sessions and hands-on knowledge transfer to Alaska Department of Health staff to ensure internal capacity for ongoing system operation, enhancement, and troubleshooting.

The Alaska Department of Health considers these outcomes to be critical to the overall implementation success of this product. The outcomes will be documented, measured, and reported throughout the life of this contract and beyond.

SEC. 2.03 CURRENT ARCHITECTURE

Below is information describing the current mix of systems that are used to determine public assistance program eligibility and administer benefits. The overall modernization strategy for the public assistance system is contained in the DOH GitHub Repository. The following is for reference only and connects to the scope of work described in Sc. 3.01 Scope of Work.

Eligibility Information System (EIS)

EIS is an "Adaptable DAta BAse System" (ADABAS) database system which resides in a mainframe environment. The database serves two separate programs: EIS and the Case Management System (CMS). Consequently, certain data files are shared between the systems.

EIS runs batch jobs to perform tasks in the following general categories:

- Interface batch jobs
- Reports batch jobs
- Notices batch jobs
- Alerts batch jobs
- Issuance batch jobs
- Database Maintenance batch jobs and
- Other batch jobs

EIS interfaces with the following systems:

- Social Security Administration (SSA) Beneficiary Data Exchange (BENDEX)
- Department of Labor and Workforce Development (DOLWD)
- SSA Supplemental Security Income (SSI) / State Data Exchange (SDX)
- SSA State Verification Exchange System (SVES) / State On-Line Query (SOLQ)
- Internal Revenue Service (IRS) Income Eligibility Verification System (IEVS)
- Beneficiary Earnings Exchange Record System (BEERS)
- Permanent Fund Dividend (PFD)
- Alaska Health Enterprise (Medicaid Management Information System (MMIS))
- Alaska Child Support Enforcement Division (CSED)
- Alaska Office of Children's Services (OCS)
- Cook Inlet Tribal Council (CITC)
- Public Assistance Reporting Information System (PARIS)
- Alaska Bureau of Vital Statistics (BVS)
- Alaska State Accounting System (IRIS)
- Electronic Benefit Transfer (EBT)
- Multivue Master Client Index (MCI)
- Finalist/Spectrum address validation
- National Directory of New Hires (NDNH)
- Interactive Voice Response (IVR) system
- Department of Education and Early Development (DEED)
- Alaska's Resource for Integrated Eligibility Services (ARIES)
- Other external website interfaces:

    - Ingens
    - SAVE - Automated Secondary Verification of Aliens' Status
- Other external applications:
    - Instant Eligibility Verification System (IEVS)
    - Current™ workflow management system
    - ILINX document management system

Integration:

The EIS mainframe environment is connected to two solutions for data integration which can be used to interact with the mainframe / EIS data.

- SoftwareAG EntireX
    - Used primarily for searching EIS data using web services and an EntireX Broker
    - Limited Dataset
    - Read Only
- SoftwareAG CONNX
    - Support for syncing data to a Relational Database (RDBMS)
    - Support for various database adapters (licensed per adapter – current license for PostgreSQL)
    - All Data Available
    - Read / Write / Update / Delete
    - Supports creation of single views (data on mainframe / RDBMS)
    - Integration layer exists for certain data elements
        - Access is currently limited, and this procurement would require additional APIs to be built to satisfy the data interoperability requirements

EIS supports benefit issuance through EBT, direct deposit, warrants, standard and non-standard Medicaid coupons, Denali KidCare ID cards, and Subsistence SNAP ID cards. The IEP supports benefit issuance through standard and non-standard Medicaid cards and coupons and Denali KidCare ID cards.

Alaska's Resource for Integrated Eligibility Services (ARIES)

The ARIES system is a core component of the IEP. DPA plans to leverage, de-couple, and extend the functionality of the ARIES system; the de-coupled ARIES will be the cornerstone of the new Integrated Eligibility Platform (IEP).

- Hosted in the Azure Commercial Cloud on a mix of:
    - Azure Infrastructure-as-a-Service (IaaS) (this includes development, staging/user testing, training, and production environments)
    - Azure Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS) (this includes Azure App Services where a person search application is hosted with an instance for development, test, and production)
    - Limited Azure Integration Services (preferred over MuleSoft)
- Department of Health data center (on premises)
    - Servers that support the unified search application (Windows-based)
- IBM-based technology stack
    - Base WAS – WebSphere Application Server
    - Network Deployment WAS – WebSphere Application Server
    - Operational Decision Management – ODM

    - IBM Security Verify Access Appliance – ISVA
- Java
    - Spring Boot Framework
- MuleSoft community edition ESB
- Quartz Enterprise Job Scheduler
- OpenText ExStream (the division is considering migrating to a new enterprise content management system (ECM))
- PostgreSQL (primary application database)
- Atlassian JIRA for issue tracking
- Azure DevOps
- Aha! (used for road mapping and deployment plans)
- Modern Requirements (tracks testing activities)
- Microsoft SQL and Microsoft SQL Server Reporting Services – SSRS

ARIES integrates & interfaces with the following systems:

- CMS Federal Data Services Hub
    - SSA Composite
    - Account Transfer
    - Non-Employer Sponsored Insurance Minimum Essential Coverage
    - FFM Referrals
    - Verify Current Income
    - Verify Lawful Presence
- Alaska's Health Information Exchange (HIE)
- Alaska Medicaid Management Information System (MMIS)
- Permanent Fund Dividend (PFD)
- Multivue Master Client Index (MCI)
- Finalist/Spectrum address validation
- National Change of Address (NCOA)
- Alaska Department of Labor
- Alaska Child Support Enforcement Division (CSED)
- Alaska Division of Public Health (DPH)
- Alaska Native Tribal Health Consortium (ANTHC)
- Eligibility Information System (EIS)
- Other external website interfaces:
    - SAVE - Automated Secondary Verification of Aliens' Status
- Other external applications:
    - Instant Eligibility Verification System (IEVS)
    - Current™ Workflow Management System
    - ILINX document management system

*Integrations primarily developed using the State's integration layer which is built in either MuleSoft or Azure Integration Services (preferred).

Both systems (EIS and the ARIES support notices and forms generation by both data entry into the system and/or by other triggers such as dates or specific case events. Generated notices are queued for nightly printing and daily

mailing at DPA Systems Support. Currently, notices and forms support English as the only language. Notices are printed in a standardized layout, font, color, etc., that may not be altered.

All notices include specific information printed on the back. System generated notices are automatically created when the case is processed, and many of these notices trigger the creation of additional notices, as defined within each system. Notices are linked to particular forms which are included in the mailing. These forms are pre-printed and come in various sizes, colors, layouts, etc.

SECTION 3. SCOPE OF WORK & CONTRACT INFORMATION

SEC. 3.01 SCOPE OF WORK

The Alaska Department of Health (DOH), Division of Public Assistance (DPA), Eligibility Modernization Project Management Office (EMO), is soliciting proposals for a contractor to achieve successful implementation of data conversion and migration as described in Milestone 2.5 of the Eligibility Modernization Roadmap.

The contractor will be responsible for migrating and converting beneficiary data from the legacy mainframe Eligibility Information System (EIS) to an efficient, scalable, and integrated platform that meets current and future business needs, as well as technical, and regulatory requirements.

Key initiatives:

- Discovery and Analysis: Assess options and develop recommendations. The contractor must align their strategy to support IEP development for eligibility determination and benefit administration under the non-MAGI Medicaid, HPE, and SNAP programs, as the converted/migrated data is essential for serving active beneficiaries. This includes assessing both current and future state systems, data models, and datasets to identify the optimal solution for enabling eligibility determination and benefit administration in the future platform, while ensuring access to historical data
- Design and architect: An appropriate data platform and associated microservices structure to support modernization roadmap objectives
- Migrate: The EIS data to a modern cloud-based data repository in Microsoft Azure
- Service integration: To the IEP API Gateway (Azure API Management and API Gateway) to support eligibility determination and benefit administration for all programs
- Design and implement: An operational data repository and reporting system/repository that is separate from the data migration efforts. The analytics system should support advanced analytics and business intelligence, and must integrate with existing tools and support secure, role-based access for users This analytics system will be built in Azure and utilize industry standard data modeling methodologies appropriate for the system's purpose.
- Include support for a distributed event management such as event streaming, message bus, or service bus based on discovery of data platform needs
- Provide the ability to connect diverse data sources for reporting and analytics

Project objectives include, but are not limited to the following:

- Ability to quickly and accurately issue all DPA program benefits based on program rules in accordance with all state and federal regulations and timeframes
- Support automated notice generation
    - All required correspondence and notices for program communication must be developed and integrated with the existing enterprise content management system (ECM), currently OpenText ExStream, but may change during the life of this contract
- Interconnect with applicable Federal and State data sources
- Integrate with the IEP, Genesys Cloud (call-center), ILINX (document management), Current™ (Change of Innovation's task management and workflow management system), Alaska Connect - Engage (client portal), IEVS (eligibility verification), etc.
- Adhere to the DOH technical Quality Assurance Plan (QAP) and related service level agreements (SLAs)

- Review and incorporate the DOH technical team prototype findings
- Enhance reporting, data access, and auditability
- Comply with all federal and state applicable security and privacy standards
- Produce documentation in accordance with the standards listed in the SEC. 2.03 Deliverables
- Support a workflow driven user experience to determine program(s) eligibility
- Support an automated application registration
- Support automated eligibility redetermination process

Additional requirements:

- Contractor shall use proven open-source libraries, where applicable, that are well supported and documented so future vendors can contribute more easily. Before any libraries are chosen, the Alaska product team will evaluate them to determine if they meet these conditions
- Contractor shall abide by best practices around unit and integration testing
- Contractor shall ensure the design aligns with the modular product design strategy from the beginning so future vendors can integrate more easily with the overall experience
- APIs should comply with the 18F API standards.
- Ideally, work will be conducted in 2-4 week sprints and reviewed at the end of each sprint. Please refer to How we work for additional information
- The contractor must ensure the system documentation is as automated as possible so that it does not have to be updated manually
- Contractor shall work with the State of Alaska to ensure that support and operations teams are trained

State Resource Utilization

DPA has made substantial investments in the ARIES system and the Integrated Eligibility Platform (IEP) and will leverage these assets to determine eligibility and administer all public assistance programs. Leverage existing state-owned technology assets and software licenses where feasible to optimize cost-effectiveness and sustainability.

The proposed solution must prioritize the use of existing state resources wherever possible. This includes maximizing current technology investments and software licenses. DPA also supports the adoption of open-source solutions and intends to share any newly developed code in public repositories to promote transparency and collaboration.

Existing infrastructure listed in Sec. 2.03:

The resulting system must also integrate with the current architecture components (link above) to meet the key objectives of all CMS required outcomes in Attachment 08 and comply with the requirements in the attached QAP. While the CMS Required Outcomes are not within the direct scope of this RFP, the contractor must ensure the metric data DPA uses to measure these required outcomes remains intact (or alternate metrics are defined based upon the converted/migrated data).

Note: The vendor will **NOT** be required to:

- Provide hosting of the data
- Directly create, update, or delete the data

SEC. 3.02 PROJECT MANAGEMENT REQUIREMENTS

PROGRAM, PROJECT, AND PRODUCT MANAGEMENT

DPA will have three related distinct and separate projects with intersecting systems, databases, and timelines in process simultaneously; this will require the selected contractor to plan and coordinate releases with state project teams, and other vendors. Additionally, DPA considers this effort to be product focused. Therefore, DPA require the skills of a Program Manager, Product Manager, and Project Manager, perspectives and as points of contact for the EMO Project Team for problem resolution, project, and program management reporting.

The **program manager** is recommended to oversee and coordinate the multiple related projects to achieve broader organizational goals.

A **Project Manager** is recommended for day-to-day project management in accordance with project management methodologies, and staffing requirements. Sprint plans will be developed collaboratively with the EMO Project Team.

Additionally, DPA considers this effort to be product focused, and therefore requires the skillset of a **Product Manager**. This individual is responsible for the product's vision, objectives, and success, and collaborates with teams across program initiatives to create a product(s) that meets user needs.

Please refer to Sec. 3.19 for supporting detail on the roles specified above.

Note, the program manager, product manager and project manager do not necessarily need to be distinct individuals; however, at least two individuals are recommended to fill these three roles.

We manage our projects using a mix of traditional agile processes.

These include the following sprint ceremonies:

- Sprint planning
- Sprint grooming
- Sprint review including product demo
- Sprint retrospective

DPA/EMO processes also include security throughout the effort; we refer to our work as DevSecOps. You can find more information about How We Work here.

A successful contractor team will have experience working with clients using modern software development approaches and include cross-functional teams using human-centered design, built with modern technology stacks, and an iterative, agile approach to deliver working software to their clients.

DAILY OPERATIONS

Daily operations will be managed by the contractor's product manager but coordinated with and communicated to the E&E Modernization Project team. They may include:

- Regularly scheduled standups via video
- Chat communications via MS Teams

- Manage and update user stories and workflow tasks in shared project management platform (Azure DevOps)

PROJECT MANAGEMENT PLAN

The contractor must deliver a simple lightweight project management plan. This deliverable should include a staffing chart, information about basic project management procedures, risk and issue identification and tracking system, and issue escalation process.

TESTING PLAN

The contractor is required to deliver a comprehensive testing plan. This plan should outline testing strategies for software developed during this agile project. The testing plan must include:

- Test Types: Detailed descriptions of all planned test types, including but not limited to:
    - Validate data extraction, transformation, and loading (ETL)
    - Confirm data integrity and completeness
    - Verify business rules and mapping logic
    - Test performance and user access in the target environment
- Execution Methods: Clear identification of the execution methods for each test type, specifying whether they will be conducted manually or automated
- Test Coverage: An explanation of how the testing will ensure coverage of all project requirements and user stories aligning with the requirements in the QAP
- Test Environments: Specifications of the test environments required and used for each type of testing proposed, including hardware, software, and network configurations.
- Test Schedule: timelines for the execution of tests, aligned with the project sprints and milestones.
- Test Data Creation: methodology for identifying and creating a representative test data set for each testing effort to ensure appropriate coverage.
- Defect Management: Procedures for tracking, reporting, and resolving defects identified during testing.
- Quality Metrics: Metrics and benchmarks that will be used to measure the quality and performance of the software in accordance with the requirements described in the QAP
- Continuous improvement processes
    - Explanation of the methods to ensure that testing results will be continuously fed back into the testing process, increasing the efficiency of future testing

STATUS REPORTS

Instead of a typical status report, the following are required to document progress throughout each sprint's period of performance:

- Links to relevant GitHub branches, pull requests, and/or commits
- Screenshots of any available visualization (as appropriate)
- Screenshot, links, or other documentation from the contractor's project management system reflecting completed features, including number and percentage of completed sprint tasks (e.g., percentage of tasks completed)
- A burndown chart showing user story completion for each sprint vs. planned work
    - Burndown towards features, epics or releases should also be included where applicable

- Ongoing information about velocity and changes to team velocity over time

DESIGN RESEARCH PLAN

The vendor shall establish a design research plan in collaboration with the E&E Modernization Project team, accounting for the availability of resources, articulation of research methods, and delivery of research-related records. In subsequent sprints, research-related records will be delivered in accordance with the approved design research plan. The intent of this plan is to describe the methods and practices that will be employed to conduct discovery, gather user feedback, incorporate changes, and ultimately produce design and documentation artifacts.

SEC. 3.03 DELIVERABLES

The contractor will be required to provide the following deliverables:

Deliverable	Due Date	Description
Project Management Plan	Within 4 weeks of contract start date	Streamlined project management plan. Details can be found in Sec 3.02
Testing Plan	Within 90 days from contract start date	Comprehensive testing plan. Details contained in Sec 3.02 Project Management Requirements
Design Research	Research-related records shall be delivered within 4 weeks of contract start date	A summary of research conducted, and results found. If applicable, the next steps or recommendations are based on research.
Data Model(s) and Data Access Plan	Delivered after 12 weeks and updated as needed	A plan that ensures that all data is accessible for reporting, auditing, and extraction in a standard format. This data may be used for multiple purposes including federal reporting, operational reports, security audits, management reporting, or program overviews.
Data Analytics Architecture and Implementation Plan	Delivered after 12 weeks and updated as needed	A plan outlining the architecture, tools, and phased implementation of a cloud-based data lake to support reporting, analytics, and business intelligence. The plan must address data ingestion, transformation, security, governance, and integration with existing systems.
Design Deliverables	End of every applicable sprint	Mockups and/or design files if applicable, or design changes reflected in the Development Prototype.
Security Documentation	At the end of every applicable sprint	Information that must be included in Division security documentation to satisfy all relevant Federal, State, and Department requirements. Note that this information is required as part of the authorization to operate (ATO) process. Authorization to operate is a requirement of system production.

Technical Documentation	At the end of every applicable sprint	All system documentation, either new or updated that results from these activities. This could include developer resources, changes to existing database, business rule documentation, network diagrams, or systems architecture documentation, etc.

DELIVERY INSTRUCTIONS

Code deliverables shall be submitted via Git Pull Requests to the Azure DevOps repository. A copy of documented deliverables shall be submitted to the Alaska E&E Modernization Project team.

INSPECTION AND ACCEPTANCE OF SERVICES

All periodic reports and deliverables shall be inspected, tested (where applicable), reviewed, and accepted by the Alaska E&E Modernization Project team, prior to sprint conclusion and deployment to the staging and production environments.

Only the Alaska E&E Modernization Project team has the authority to inspect, accept, or reject all deliverables. Acceptance of services and deliverables will be based on the criteria laid out in the QAP.

SYSTEM DOCUMENTATION

The contractor shall consult with the Alaska E&E Modernization Project team to determine what is appropriate, effective, and essential for system documentation. The state requires, at a minimum, that the contractor generates comprehensive and complete documentation, both within the code itself, within the source code version control system (e.g., through proper use of descriptive 'commit' messages, issue tracking, pull requests, etc.), and as appropriate, in separate documentation, provide artifacts, and create new user stories based on each sprint.

We house documentation in Azure DevOps either in the built-in wiki, or as part of a repository. This allows document versioning. DOH, DPA expects the selected contractor to create and update documentation using these standards where appropriate.

QUALITY ASSURANCE

The contractor shall comply with the acceptable quality levels (AQL) as described in the attached quality assurance plan QAP.

SEC. 3.04 TRANSTION REQUIREMENTS

TRANSITION ACTIVITIES

Upon contract completion or termination, the contractor or shall provide DPA with all related intellectual property.

The contractor shall:

a) Ensure and agree that all deliverables, products, licenses, designs, data, documentation, tests, user research notes, source code, configuration settings and files, and materials developed throughout this contract are the property of the State of Alaska and in the public domain

b) During the transition to the State of Alaska and/or a new contractor, the contractor shall perform all necessary transition activities, including, but not limited to,

- Continue full services to DPA during transition period.
- Participation, at the discretion of Alaska technical team, in meetings with the State of Alaska or a new contractor to ensure a smooth transition and provide detailed information on the operation of all deliverables
- Train new personnel (contractor or State) during transition period
- Appropriate close-out of outstanding technical and related work

c) Deliver a final report that includes a list of completed sprint tasks, documentation, and links to code repository.

Should the Contract be terminated prior to the end of the period of performance, the contractor shall transfer all project materials to the procurement officer within ninety (90) days of the procurement officer's request deliverables

The contractor is required to provide the following deliverables:

Deliverable	**Due Date**	**Description**
Code & Status Reports	1 business day after each sprint	Demonstration of progress throughout each sprint. This should include a ship or progress update report to include team activities and accomplishments.
Code Repository of Product	Continuously delivered throughout contract	Version-controlled Open-Source repository of code that comprises product. Any incomplete code will be delivered at end-of-contract. Code repository should include any relevant tests.
Research	Research-related records shall be delivered at the end of the third sprint and every applicable sprint thereafter	A summary of research conducted, and results found. If applicable next steps or recommendations based on research.
Design Deliverables	End of every applicable sprint	Mockups and/or design files if applicable, or design changes reflected in the Development Prototype.
Training Materials	Following an agreed upon timeline and prior to eligibility worker use	All related training materials including screenshots, how-to guides, workflow diagrams etc.
Security Documentation	At the end of every applicable sprint	Information to satisfy all relevant Federal, State, and Department requirements. Note that this is required as part of the authorization to operate process. Authorization to operate is a requirement of system production.
Technical Documentation	At the end of every applicable sprint	All system documentation, either new or updated that results from these activities. This could include developer resources, changes to existing databases, business rule documentation, network diagrams, or systems architecture documentation, etc.

Deliverable	Due Date	Description
Project Management Plan	At the end of Sprint 2	Streamlined project management plan. Details can be found in Sec 3.02
Testing Plan	At the end of Sprint 6	Comprehensive testing plan. Details contained in Sec 3.02
Design Research Plan	At the end of Sprint 2	Details can be found in Sec 3.02
Usability Plan	At the end of Sprint 2	Details can be found in Sec 3.02

DELIVERY INSTRUCTIONS

Code deliverables shall be submitted via Git PRs (Pull Requests) to the Azure DevOps repository. A copy of document deliverables shall be submitted to the DPA Eligibility Modernization Office (EMO).

INSPECTION AND ACCEPTANCE OF SERVICES

All periodic reports and deliverables shall be inspected, tested (where applicable), reviewed, and accepted by the EMO, prior to sprint conclusion and deployment to the staging and production environments.

Only the EMO has the authority to inspect, accept, or reject all deliverables.

Acceptance of services and deliverables will be based on the criteria laid out in the QAP.

SYSTEM DOCUMENTATION

The contractor shall consult with the EMO to determine what is appropriate, effective, and essential for system documentation. The state requires, at a minimum, the contractor generates comprehensive and complete documentation, both within the code itself, within the source code version control system (e.g., through proper use of descriptive commit messages, issue tracking, pull requests, etc.), and as appropriate, in separate documentation, provide artifacts, and create new user stories based on each sprint.

We house documentation in Azure DevOps either in the built-in wiki, or as part of a repository. This allows document versioning. The EMO expects the selected contractor to create and update documentation using these standards where appropriate.

QUALITY ASSURANCE

The contractor shall comply with the acceptable quality levels (AQL) as described in the attached QAP.

SEC. 3.05 HIPAA SECURITY ASSESSMENT REQUIREMENTS

Once the contract is executed and prior to beginning any other work under the contract, the contractor shall work with the Department of Health (DOH) Security Office to complete a full security assessment for the proposed software or system solution(s). This may include, but not be limited to:

- Clearly articulating the components of the system which DOH staff are expected to configure and administer and, likewise, which components of the system the contractor will configure and administer.

- Information System/Data Flow Diagram outlining all major components of the system (system type and technologies employed) and their interconnections (protocols and payloads).
- Interconnection Risk Assessment Worksheet (IRAW) for each outbound or inbound interconnection outlined in the Information System/Data Flow Diagram and any ancillary Application Programming Interface (API) or data transfers.
- A code scanning attestation which confirms the offeror performs MITRE conformant code scanning (CWE) against each deployable version of the code base and remediates CWE flaws of medium, or higher, technical impact.
- A server vulnerability scanning attestation confirming that the offeror performs regular vulnerability scanning against all in-scope servers and remediates identified vulnerabilities in a timely manner.
- Completion of the DOH NIST CSF Assessment Questions (see next RFP Section).

Follow up clarification questions from the DOH's Security Assessor may be required. The software or system solution(s) must receive an Authority to Operate (ATO) from the Security Assessor prior to being deployed. If the ATO is not issued, the State is not responsible for any additional costs and reserves the right to terminate the contract immediately.

This security assessment may also be performed every three years during the contract. All contractor costs for the security assessment must be included in the offeror's cost proposal. Those costs will be paid only upon completion of the security assessment and issuance of the ATO from the Security Assessor.

SEC. 3.06 INTENT TO PROPOSE AND NON-DISCLOSURE AGREEMENT (NDA)

Offerors are strongly encouraged to obtain the NIST CSF Assessment Questions List indicated in the previous RFP section prior to submitting their proposal, as it is intended to further determine the level of effort and cost for the security assessment. To obtain the NIST CSF Assessment Questions List, the offeror must complete and submit an intent to propose and non-disclosure agreement, provided as an attachment to this RFP. The signed agreement must be emailed to the procurement officer as an attachment and the offeror must also provide the phone number and email address of the person who is to receive the file. The file will then be provided by the procurement officer to the offeror.

The procurement officer will not provide the file until receipt of the completed and signed intent to propose and non-disclosure agreement. The state reserves the right to clarify and verify any offeror's ability to perform the services required under this solicitation prior to granting access to the file. The state is not responsible for an offeror's failure to obtain the NIST CSF Assessment Questions List; the total costs identified for the security assessment on the offeror's cost proposal shall be the total costs paid by the state. No additional charges shall be allowed.

SEC. 3.07 INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY (IT) RELATED CONTRACTUAL REQUIREMENTS

Other specific DOH IT-related contractual requirements are provided in Submittal Form G – DOH IT Contractual Requirements. The offeror must complete this spreadsheet in accordance with the provided instructions; space is provided to provide both choose a response (see the drop-down list) and provide further explanation.

Note that in some cases, certain initial elements of the HIPAA Security Assessment indicated in Sec. 3.05 HIPAA Security Assessment Requirements may be completed during the negotiation phase based on the offeror's response to these contractual requirements.

SEC. 3.08 CONTRACT TERM AND WORK SCHEDULE

The length of the contract will be from the date of the award until completion, approximately eighteen months.

Any extension of the contract beyond the exercised renewal options will be upon mutual agreement between the State and the contractor and effected with a contract amendment processed by the procurement officer and signed by both parties. All other terms and conditions of the contract, including those previously amended, shall remain in full force and effect. Unless otherwise agreed to by both parties, the procurement officer will provide written notice to the contractor of the intent to cancel an extension at least 30 days before the desired date of cancellation.

SEC. 3.09 CONTRACT TYPE

This contract is a firm fixed price contract.

SEC. 3.10 PAYMENT PROCEDURES

The state will make monthly payments based on the hourly rates identified in Attachment 03 Submittal Form H – Cost Proposal. Each billing must consist of an invoice and progress report. No payment will be made until the progress report and invoice have been approved by the project director.

SEC. 3.11 CONTRACT PAYMENT

No payment will be made until the contract is approved by the Commissioner of the Department of Health or the Commissioner's designee. The state is not responsible for and will not pay local, state, or federal taxes. All costs associated with the contract must be stated in U.S. currency.

For agreements over $500,000, under no conditions will the state be liable for the payment of any interest charges associated with the cost of the contract. Payment for agreements under $500,000 for the undisputed purchase of goods or services provided to a state agency will be made within 30 days of the receipt of a proper billing or the delivery of the goods or services to the location(s) specified in the agreement, whichever is later. A late payment is subject to 1.5% interest per month on the unpaid balance. Interest will not be paid if there is a dispute or if there is an agreement that establishes a lower interest rate or precludes the charging of interest.

SEC. 3.12 ELECTRONIC PAYMENTS

The State of Alaska prefers vendors to receive payment via Electronic Funds Transfer (EFT). The contractor may review information concerning the EFT process and access the Electronic Payment Agreement Form for Vendors at the following link: https://doa.alaska.gov/dof/vendor.html.

Any single contract payment of $1 million or higher must be accepted by the contractor via Electronic Funds Transfer (EFT).

SEC. 3.13 LOCATION OF WORK

The location(s) the work is to be performed, completed and managed is at the discretion of the contractor as long as the location complies with the requirements below.

The state will provide limited workspace for the contractor (1-2 desk spaces, co-located with DOH staff during contract specific travel). The contractor must otherwise provide its own workspace.

We anticipate much of this work to be performed remotely with close collaboration between the project team via digital communication methods. There may be some occasions where an on-site visit is required, but those will be the exception rather than the rule. All equipment (laptops, printers, internet access, etc.) must be supplied by the contractor and must meet physical and information safeguards as defined by DOH staff.

Contractor staff must be available to participate in project-related meetings as scheduled by DOH staff with the State of Alaska's normal business hours (8:00AM–5:00PM Alaska Prevailing Time).

The contractor should include in their price proposal cost estimates for: transportation, lodging, and per diem costs sufficient for 1-2 people to make 1-2 trips to 3601 C Street, Suite 490, Anchorage, AK 99503 or 333 Willoughby Ave. Suite 700, Juneau, AK. 99801. Travel to other locations will not be required.

By signature on their proposal, the offeror certifies that all services provided under this contract by the contractor and all subcontractors shall be performed in the United States.

If the offeror cannot certify that all work will be performed in the United States, the offeror must contact the procurement officer in writing to request a waiver at least 10 days prior to the deadline for receipt of proposals.

The request must include a detailed description of the portion of work that will be performed outside the United States, where, by whom, and the reason the waiver is necessary.

Failure to comply with these requirements may cause the state to reject the proposal as non-responsive or cancel the contract.

SEC. 3.14 THIRD-PARTY SERVICE PROVIDERS

The contractor must provide, on an annual basis, a Type 2 Statement on Standards for Attestation Engagements (SSAE) SOC 2 report(s). Failure to provide these reports may be treated as a material breach and may be a basis for a finding of default.

SEC. 3.15 SUBCONTRACTORS

Subcontractors may be used to perform work under this contract. If an offeror intends to use subcontractors, the offeror must complete Submittal Form F identified in Sec. 4.02 Special Formatting Requirements of this RFP.

An offeror's failure to provide this information with their proposal may cause the state to consider their proposal non-responsive and reject it.

Subcontractor experience shall not be considered in determining whether the offeror meets the requirements set forth in Submittal Form E.

If a proposal with subcontractors is selected, the state may require a signed written statement from each subcontractor that clearly verifies the subcontractor is committed to providing the good or services required by the contract.

The substitution of one subcontractor for another may be made only at the discretion and prior written approval of the project director or procurement officer.

Note that if the subcontractor will not be performing work within Alaska, they will not be required to hold an Alaska business license.

SEC. 3.16 JOINT VENTURES

Joint ventures will not be allowed.

SEC. 3.17 RIGHT TO INSPECT PLACE OF BUSINESS

At reasonable times, the state may inspect those areas of the contractor's place of business that are related to the performance of a contract. If the state makes such an inspection, the contractor must provide reasonable assistance.

SEC. 3.18 RIGHT OF CMS AUDIT AND INSPECTION

Throughout the life of the contract, the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS), Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) and its contractors have the right to conduct onsite or offsite evaluation of services performed by the contractor and to audit and inspect contractor information, data, and records. These rights are in addition to Article 2 of Appendix A of this contract, Attachment 04, which provides for Inspections and Reports that may be conducted by the Department of Health.

SEC. 3.19 CONTRACT PERSONNEL

Any change of the project team members or subcontractors named in the proposal must be approved, in advance and in writing, by the project director or procurement officer. Changes that are not approved by the state may be grounds for the state to terminate the contract.

DOH envisions the need for the following roles and skillsets as part of the contractor team:

Role	Responsibility
Program Manager	The program manager oversees and coordinates multiple related projects to achieve broader organizational goals. The focus is on the strategic direction of a program, ensuring alignment with business objectives and successful delivery of outcomes. While not directly managing individual projects, the program manager provides oversight, guidance, and support to project managers.
Product Manager	Responsible for the product's overall impact on the business; focus is on product development and strategy. Collaborates with teams across the organization to create products that meet customer needs and align with the product's vision. The Product manager uses strategic thinking, data analytics, and communication skills to prioritize initiatives, set goals, and define features.
Project Manager	Responsible for planning (in accordance with project goals, timelines and budget), overseeing development (this includes resource management), delivery and deployment of software, and overall communication - keeping stakeholders updated on project progress and seeking their input throughout the project lifecycle.

Role	Responsibility
Data Engineers	Responsible for designing, building, and maintaining scalable data systems and pipelines to collect, store, and process data for analysis and reporting. Key responsibilities include developing data infrastructure like data lakes and warehouses, ensuring data quality and security, collaborating with other vendors and analysts, and optimizing data accessibility for business insights.

DESIRED SKILLS AND KNOWLEDGE

The DOH vision on overall architecture of the application can be found here.

It would be helpful if the contractor team had knowledge and skills in the following areas:

- Current Eligibility System Technology: IBM WebSphere, IBM Operational Decision Manager, IBM Security Access Manager, Mule ESB, OpenText Exstream, Quartz Scheduler, built on Java frameworks
- Microsoft Technology: Azure cloud platform, Azure SQL Server, Azure API Gateway, Azure Container Service
- General Technology: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Responsive design, SQL (language), Git, Experience working with, using, and building REST APIs, Service-based architecture, automated unit and integration testing, continuous integration and continuous delivery (CI/CD)
- Security: Minimal Acceptable Risk Standards for Exchanges (MARS-E) 2.2/ARC-AMPE Framework, CMS security review processes

KEY PERSONNEL

The following requirements related to personnel must be met:

a) The contractor shall assign to perform this contract those persons whose résumés are submitted with their quotation and who are identified in the contractor's quotation as Key Personnel.

b) At a minimum, a Program, Product and Project Manager, (DPA recommend a minimum of two individuals to fill these roles) and Data Architect, and Data Engineer-Lead must be identified and designated as Key Personnel.

The ***Program Manager*** will be responsible for overseeing and coordinating and collaborating with multiple projects, and teams across the organization, related initiatives, and other vendors/contractors to ensure the project's organizational and product goals are achieved. Experience in project management is crucial, knowledge of project management methodologies and tools.

- Strong leadership skills
- Strong written and oral communication skills
- Problem-solving abilities
- Experience in managing stakeholders across different departments or organizations is also important

The Program Manager should have a minimum of three (3) years' experience in the last five (5) years leading a project for a health and human services organization gained through progressively larger and more complex projects.

The ***Product Manager(s)*** The Product Manager will be responsible for aligning the product vision with related roadmap initiatives and creating product(s) that meet customer needs and satisfy business objectives, collaborating closely with teams across the organization, related initiatives, and other vendors/contractors.

The Product Manager should have a minimum of three (3) years' experience in the last five (5) years leading a project for a health and human services organization gained through progressively larger and more complex projects.

The ***Project Manager*** will be a direct liaison to DPA's Eligibility Modernization Office. The Product Manager is responsible for the supervision and management of the contractor's personnel, overall technical solution and budget. Desired skills/experience for the Project Manager include:

- Experience in technical leadership
- Strong ability in agile product management techniques
- Ability to rapidly prioritize competing requirements
- Ability in technical work estimation techniques
- Ability to understand and simplify customer requirements
- Ability to communicate end-user feedback to technical and design leads
- Strong written and oral communication skills
- Proven knowledge of industry standards

The Project *Manager* should have a minimum of three (3) years' experience in the last five (5) years leading a project for a health and human services organization. This experience should be reflected in the proposed Product Manager's resume.

The ***Data Architect*** the Data Architect's job is to design, create, and manage an organization's data infrastructure, including data models, databases, data lakes, and data warehouses, ensuring data is stored, integrated, and accessed efficiently, securely, and in compliance with regulations. Key responsibilities include analyzing business needs to create data blueprints, developing data governance standards, optimizing data systems, and collaborating with data engineers and other stakeholders to align data architecture with strategic goals.

- Analyzes existing data systems to identify inefficiencies and areas for improvement
- Develops strategic plans and models for the organization's future data infrastructure
- Builds and maintains the underlying structure for data storage and retrieval
- Designs systems that enable efficient and reliable movement of data between different platforms
- Creates and maintains procedures and standards for managing data

The Data Architect should have a minimum of three (3) years' experience in the last five (5) years in a technical leadership role.

The ***Data Engineer-Lead*** must have a full understanding of the technical approach discussed in the proposal interview and is responsible for ensuring that the contractor follows the proposed approach.

The *Data Engineer - Lead* should have a minimum of three (3) years' experience in the last five (5) years in a technical leadership role.

SEC. 3.20 INSPECTION & MODIFICATION - REIMBURSEMENT FOR UNACCEPTABLE DELIVERABLES

The contractor is responsible for the completion of all the work set out in the contract. All work is subject to inspection, evaluation, and approval by the project director. The state may employ all reasonable means to ensure that the work is progressing and being performed in compliance with the contract. The project director or procurement officer may instruct the contractor to make corrections or modifications if needed to accomplish the contract's intent. The contractor will not unreasonably withhold such changes.

Substantial failure of the contractor to perform the contract may cause the state to terminate the contract. In this event, the state may require the contractor to reimburse monies paid (based on the identified portion of unacceptable work received) and may seek associated damages.

SEC. 3.21 CONTRACT CHANGES - UNANTICIPATED AMENDMENTS

During the course of this contract, the contractor may be required to perform additional work. That work will be within the general scope of the initial contract. When additional work is required, the project director will provide the contractor with a written description of the additional work and request the contractor to submit a firm time schedule for accomplishing the additional work and a firm price for the additional work. Cost and pricing data must be provided to justify the cost of such amendments per AS 36.30.400.

The contractor will not commence additional work until the procurement officer has secured any required state approvals necessary for the amendment and issued a written contract amendment, approved by the Commissioner of the Department of Health or the Commissioner's designee.

SEC. 3.22 NONDISCLOSURE AND CONFIDENTIALITY

The contractor agrees that all confidential information shall be used only for purposes of providing the deliverables and performing the services specified herein and shall not disseminate or allow dissemination of confidential information except as provided for in this section. The contractor shall hold as confidential and will use reasonable care (including both facility physical security and electronic security) to prevent unauthorized access by storage, disclosure, publication, dissemination to and/or use by third parties of, the confidential information. "Reasonable care" means compliance by the contractor with all applicable federal and state law, including the Social Security Act and HIPAA. The contractor must promptly notify the state in writing if it becomes aware of any storage, disclosure, loss, unauthorized access to or use of the confidential information.

Confidential information, as used herein, means any data, files, software, information or materials (whether prepared by the state or its agents or advisors) in oral, electronic, tangible or intangible form and however stored, compiled or memorialized that is classified confidential as defined by State of Alaska classification and categorization guidelines provided by the state to the contractor or a contractor agent or otherwise made available to the contractor or a contractor agent in connection with this contract, or acquired, obtained or learned by the contractor or a contractor agent in the performance of this contract. Examples of confidential information include but are not limited to technology infrastructure, architecture, financial data, trade secrets, equipment specifications, user lists, passwords, research data, and technology data (infrastructure, architecture, operating systems, security tools, IP addresses, etc.).

Additional information the contractor shall hold as confidential during the performance of services under this contract includes:

DEPARTMENT'S SECURITY ASSESSMENT PROCESS AND DOCUMENTS

If confidential information is requested to be disclosed by the contractor pursuant to a request received by a third party and such disclosure of the confidential information is required under applicable state or federal law, regulation, governmental or regulatory authority, the contractor may disclose the confidential information after providing the state with written notice of the requested disclosure (to the extent such notice to the state is permitted by applicable law) and giving the state opportunity to review the request. If the contractor receives no objection from the state, it may release confidential information within 30 days. Notice of the requested disclosure of confidential information by the contractor must be provided to the state within a reasonable time after the contractor's receipt of notice of the requested disclosure and, upon the request of the state, shall seek to obtain legal protection from the release of the confidential information.

The following information shall not be considered confidential information: information previously known to be public information when received from the other party; information freely available to the general public; information which now is or hereafter becomes publicly known by other than a breach of confidentiality hereof; or information which is disclosed by a party pursuant to subpoena or other legal process and which as a result becomes lawfully obtainable by the general public.

SEC. 3.23 INDEMNIFICATION

The contractor shall indemnify, hold harmless, and defend the contracting agency from and against any third-party claim of, or liability for error, omission or negligent act of the contractor under this agreement. The contractor shall not be required to indemnify the contracting agency for a claim of, or liability for, the independent negligence of the contracting agency. If there is a claim of, or liability for, the joint negligent error or omission of the contractor and the independent negligence of the contracting agency, the indemnification and hold harmless obligation shall be apportioned on a comparative fault basis. "Contractor" and "contracting agency", as used within this and the following article, include the employees, agents and other contractors who are directly responsible, respectively, to each. The term "independent negligence" is negligence other than in the contracting agency's selection, administration, monitoring, or controlling of the contractor and in approving or accepting the contractor's work.

SEC. 3.24 INSURANCE REQUIREMENTS

Without limiting contractor's indemnification, it is agreed that contractor shall purchase at its own expense and maintain in force at all times during the performance of services under this agreement the following policies of insurance. Where specific limits are shown, it is understood that they shall be the minimum acceptable limits. If the contractor's policy contains higher limits, the state shall be entitled to coverage to the extent of such higher limits.

Certificates of Insurance must be furnished to the procurement officer prior to beginning work and must provide for a notice of cancellation, non-renewal, or material change of conditions in accordance with policy provisions. Failure to provide satisfactory evidence of insurance or lapses of the policy is a material breach of this contract and shall be grounds for termination of the contractor's services. All insurance policies shall comply with and be issued by insurers licensed to transact the business of insurance under AS 21.

Workers' Compensation Insurance: The contractor shall provide and maintain, for all employees engaged in work under this contract, coverage as required by AS 23.30.045, and where applicable, any other statutory obligations including but not limited to Federal U.S.L. & H. and Jones Act requirements. The policy must waive subrogation against the State.

Commercial General Liability Insurance: covering all business premises and operations used by the Contractor in the performance of services under this agreement with minimum coverage limits of $300,000 combined single limit per claim.

Commercial Automobile Liability Insurance: covering all vehicles used by the contractor in the performance of services under this agreement with minimum coverage limits of $300,000 combined single limit per claim.

Professional Liability Insurance: covering all errors, omissions, or negligent acts in the performance of professional services under this agreement with minimum coverage limits of $10,000,000 per claim /annual aggregate.

SEC. 3.25 TERMINATION FOR DEFAULT

If the project director or procurement officer determines that the contractor has refused to perform the work or has failed to perform the work with such diligence as to ensure its timely and accurate completion, the state may, by providing written notice to the contractor, terminate the contractor's right to proceed with part or all the remaining work.

The procurement officer may also, by written notice, terminate the contract under Administrative Order 352 if the contractor supports or participates in a boycott of the State of Israel.

This clause does not restrict the state's termination rights under the contract provisions of Appendix A, attached Attachment 04 in SEC. 7 ATTACHMENTS.

SEC. 3.26 TERMINATION AND SYSTEM OPERATION

If the contract is terminated, within 30 days prior to termination the contractor must provide the State all materials necessary for continued operation, including:

- computer programs
- data files
- user and operations manuals
- system and program documentation
- training programs related to the operation and maintenance of the system

If the contractor has proprietary rights to any of the above materials, the State has one of two options:

1) the right to purchase the materials
2) the right to lease the materials

Either of these two options will require mutual good faith discussion and finalization of an agreement between the State and contractor prior to the contract termination date.

SECTION 4. PROPOSAL FORMAT AND CONTENT

SEC. 4.01 RFP SUBMITTAL FORMS

This RFP contains Submittal Forms, which must be completed by the offeror and submitted as their proposal. An electronic copy of the forms is posted along with this RFP see SEC. 7 – Attachments. Offerors shall not re-create these forms, create their own forms, or edit the format structure of the forms unless permitted to do so.

Unless otherwise specified in this RFP, the Submittal Forms shall be the offeror's entire proposal. Do not include any marketing information in the proposal or it may be removed by the procurement officer prior to the proposals being sent to the proposal evaluation committee (PEC).

Any proposal that does not follow these requirements may be deemed non-responsive and rejected.

SEC. 4.02 SPECIAL FORMATTING REQUIREMENTS

The offeror must ensure that their proposal meets all special formatting requirements identified in this section.

Documents and Text: All attachment documents must be written in the English language, be single sided, and be single spaced with a minimum font size of 10. Pictures or graphics may be used if the offeror feels it is necessary to communicate their information, however, be aware of the requirements for page limits below.

Page Limits: Some Submittal Forms listed below have maximum page limit requirements. Offerors must not exceed the maximum page limits. Note, the page limit applies to the front side of a page only (for example, 1 Page' implies that the offeror can only provide a response on one side of a piece of paper).

Submittal Form	Maximum Page Limits
Submittal Form A – Offeror Information and Certifications	N/A
Submittal Form B – Experience and Qualifications	**10**
Submittal Form C – Technical Understanding and Approach	**15**
Submittal Form D – Product Management Approach	**5**
Submittal Form E – Mandatory Requirements	N/A
Submittal Form F – DOH IT Contractual Requirements	N/A
Submittal Form G – Subcontractors	N/A
Submittal Form H – Cost Proposal	N/A

Any Submittal Form that is being evaluated and does not follow these instructions may receive a '1' score for the evaluated Submittal Form, or the entire response may be deemed non-responsive and rejected. Failure to submit any of the Submittal Forms will result in the proposal being deemed non-responsive and rejected.

SEC. 4.03 OFFEROR INFORMATION AND CERTIFICATIONS (SUBMITTAL FORM A)

The offeror must complete and submit this Submittal Form. The form must be signed by an individual authorized to bind the offeror to the provisions of the RFP.

By signature on the form, the offeror certifies they comply with the items listed in the Certifications section of the Submittal Form. If the offeror fails to comply with these items, the state reserves the right to disregard the proposal, consider the contractor in default, or terminate the contract.

The Submittal Form also requests the following information:

a) The complete name and address of the offeror's firm along with the offeror's Tax ID.

b) Information on the person the state should contact regarding the proposal.

c) Names of critical team members/personnel.

d) Addenda acknowledgement.

e) Conflict of interest statement.

An offeror's failure to provide this information may cause the proposal to be determined to be non-responsive and rejected.

SEC. 4.04 EXPERIENCE AND QUALIFICATIONS (SUBMITTAL FORM B)

Offerors must provide detail on their experience in accordance with the specifications listed below Additionally, offerors must detail the primary project manager's specific experience with similar projects, along with the directly related experience of the overall project team as identified in Submittal Form A.

The offeror must provide two examples of recently developed technical projects. While not required, we strongly prefer that at least one of these projects have been developed and released using open-source principles and licensing. The examples provided must reflect aspects of data security and should show aspects of strong user driven design in a web application. The projects must have been delivered by either:

a) the offeror itself or, alternatively,

b) a subcontractor that is proposed in response to this RFP, or, alternatively,

c) any Key Personnel that are being proposed in response to this RFP. In the project summary, be sure to identify how the offeror's team was involved in the development.

Note: We prefer links to a public software repository that includes the source code that was developed and accepted for the project. Actual access to a publicly available repository is strongly encouraged over screenshots of private repositories. The summary must also include live links of the final product or current staging environment. If live links are not available, screenshots can be provided, along with a brief explanation as to why the project is no longer live. Note that screenshots will not be counted towards your page limitation; please provide screenshots as attachments. The projects should be recent and similar to the size and technical scope of this requirement.

Offeror must demonstrate experience working on projects for clients using multiple types of software development lifecycle approaches. These approaches must include cross-functional teams that use human-centered design, build with modern technology stacks, and use an iterative, agile approach to continuously deliver working software to their clients.

The *Product Manager* must have experience of leading a project for a health and human services organization.

The *Technical Lead* should have a full understanding of the technical approach discussed in the proposal interview and is responsible for ensuring that the contractor follows the proposed approach. The Technical Lead must have experience in a technical leadership role.

Offerors must also provide a narrative description of the organization of the project team and a personnel roster that identifies lines of authority. For each identified key staff member who will work on the contract, please provide the following:

- Title and identification of the work this individual will be responsible for
- Resume and specifically related work experience for key personnel

Offerors must provide information describing work completed of a similar scope and complexity. Please provide experience with similar technologies including data architecture, data engineering and integration, human-centered design, and continuous deployment methods.

Information about similar experiences and qualifications is included as part of your page limitation.

Provide a staffing approach that describes your understanding of the responsibilities and details the number or personnel by skill level/labor category needed to satisfy Section Sec. 3.01 Scope of Work as well as Sec. 3.19 Contract Personnel.

At a minimum, in this section, provide:

- A description of your staffing methodology based on your understanding of the scope and project desired outcomes
- A breakdown of labor categories, including the title, number of personnel, and hours; and
- A list of Key Personnel by name, title, contact information, proposed duties and roles, and resumes for each proposed Key Personnel in accordance Sec. 3.19 Contract Personnel. Resumes should include a description of the experience and capability for all Key Personnel proposed for the offeror's project team. Resumes should also address the individual's technical background, education, work experience, and accomplishments related to the activities described in this RFP. The proposal of any key personnel not currently employed by the offeror or teaming partners shall be accompanied by letters of intent signed by proposed Key Personnel.

The staffing approach is included as part of your page limitation; however, resumes and letters of intent or recommendations are not included in the page limitation.

SPECIAL NOTE: The offeror shall not disclose their costs in this Submittal Form. This Submittal cannot exceed the page limit, as described in Sec. 4.02 Special Formatting Requirements.

SEC. 4.05 TECHNICAL UNDERSTANDING AND APPROACH (SUBMITTAL FORM C)

Succinctly describe the offeror's level of knowledge, technical expertise and overall understanding of the responsibilities as set forth in Section 3.01: Scope of Work and Section 3.03 Deliverables. This section should include your proposed plans to adhere to the technical requirements and standards listed out in Attachment 1, attached in Sec 7. Attachments.

SPECIAL NOTE: The offeror shall not disclose their costs in this Submittal Form. This Submittal Form cannot exceed the page limit as described in Sec. 4.02 Special Formatting Requirements.

SEC. 4.06 PRODUCT MANAGEMENT APPROACH (SUBMITTAL FORM D)

Succinctly describe your approach to the following areas of product management:

- Product Coordination – Describe how you will manage the necessary coordination of the different stakeholder groups both within the state and within your teams. How you will handle team communication, meeting scheduling, and day-to-day information sharing. How you plan to coordinate both the agile ceremonies needed for new work, as well as the support ticket process with the existing helpdesk team and systems
- Risk Management – Discuss how the identification, classification, mitigation, and documentation of risks would be addressed
- Issue Management – Discuss how issues will be identified, addressed, or escalated as needed
- Testing – Describe your philosophy of testing, and how you would work with the state technical support teams to integrate into the shared CI/CD pipeline. Describe how you envision incorporating user testing
- Design Research Coordination – Describe an overview of your research process and how that will tie in with other delivery activities

SPECIAL NOTE: The offeror shall not disclose their costs in this Submittal Form. This Submittal Form cannot exceed the page limit, as described in Sec. 4.02 Special Formatting Requirements.

SEC. 4.07 MANDATORY REQUIREMENTS (SUBMITTAL FORM E)

Offerors must complete and submit this Submittal Form.

SEC. 4.08 SUBCONTRACTORS (SUBMITTAL FORM F)

If using subcontractors, the offeror must complete and submit this Submittal Form.

SEC. 4.09 DOH IT CONTRACTUAL REQUIREMENTS (SUBMITTAL FORM G)

Offerors must complete and submit this Submittal Form

SEC. 4.10 COST PROPOSAL (SUBMITTAL FORM H)

Offerors must complete and submit this Submittal Form.

SECTION 5. EVALUATION CRITERIA AND CONTRACTOR SELECTION

SEC. 5.01 SUMMARY OF EVALUATION PROCESS

The state will use the following steps to evaluate and prioritize proposals:

1) Proposals will be assessed for overall responsiveness. Proposals deemed non-responsive will be eliminated from further consideration.
2) A proposal evaluation committee (PEC), made up of at least three state employees or public officials, will evaluate specific parts of the responsive proposals.
3) The Submittal Forms, from each responsive proposal, will be sent to the PEC. No cost information will be shared or provided to the PEC.
4) The PEC will independently evaluate and score the documents based on the degree to which they meet the stated evaluation criteria.
5) After independent scoring, the PEC will have a meeting, chaired by the procurement officer, where the PEC may have a group discussion prior to finalizing their scores.
6) The evaluators will submit their final individual scores to the procurement officer, who will then compile the scores and calculate awarded points as set out in Sec. 5.03 Scoring Method and Calculation.
7) The procurement officer will calculate scores for cost proposals as set out in Sec. 5.07 Contract Cost (Cost Proposal) and add those scores to the awarded points.
8) The procurement officer may prioritize the proposals, and the state may conduct interviews with the top-rated offerors.
9) The PEC will evaluate and score the interviews, and the procurement officer will compile the final scores.
10) The state may then conduct contract negotiations with the most advantageous offeror and award a contract if the negotiations are successful.

SEC. 5.02 EVALUATION CRITERIA

Proposals will be evaluated based on their overall value to state, considering both cost and non-cost factors as described below. Note: An evaluation may not be based on discrimination due to the race, religion, color, national origin, sex, age, marital status, pregnancy, parenthood, disability, or political affiliation of the offeror.

Overall Criteria	**Weight**
Responsiveness	Pass/Fail
Mandatory Requirements Compliance (Submittal Form F)	

Technical Criteria		**Weight**
Experience and Qualifications	(Submittal Form B)	200
Technical Understanding and Approach	(Submittal Form C)	200
Product Management Approach	(Submittal Form D)	100
	Total	500

Cost Criteria		Weight
Cost Proposal	(Submittal Form H)	250
	Total	250

Interview		Weight
Interview (if applicable)		250
	Total	250

TOTAL EVALUATION POINTS AVAILABLE: 1000

SEC. 5.03 SCORING METHOD AND CALCULATION

The PEC will evaluate responses against the questions set out in SEC. 4.04 through 4.07 and assign a single score for each section. Offerors' responses for each section may be rated comparatively against one another with each PEC member assigning a score of 1, 5, or 10 (with 10 representing the highest score, 5 representing the average score, and 1 representing the lowest score). Responses that are similar or lack dominant information to differentiate the offerors from each other will receive the same score. Therefore, it is the offeror's responsibility to provide dominant information and differentiate themselves from their competitors.

After the PEC has scored each section, the scores for each section will be totaled and the following formula will be used to calculate the points awarded for that section:

1) Maximum Points Available / Maximum Combined PEC Score Possible
2) Combined PEC Score x Result of 1)

Example (Maximum Points Available for the Section = 100):

	PEC Member 1 Score	PEC Member 2 Score	PEC Member 3 Score	PEC Member 4 Score	Combined Total Score	Points Awarded
Offeror 1	10	5	5	10	30	75
Offeror 2	5	5	5	5	20	50
Offeror 3	10	10	10	10	40	100

Offeror 1 was awarded 75 points:

$$\frac{\text{Maximum Points Available (100)}}{\text{Maximum Combined PEC Score Possible (40)}} = 2.5$$

Combined PEC Score (30) x 2.5 = Points Awarded (75)

Offeror 2 was awarded 50 points:

$$\frac{\text{Maximum Points Available (100)}}{\text{Maximum Combined PEC Score Possible (40)}} = 2.5$$

Combined PEC Score (20) x 2.5 = Points Awarded (50)

Offeror 3 was awarded 100 points:

$$\frac{\text{Maximum Points Available (100)}}{\text{Maximum Combined PEC Score Possible (40)}} = 2.5$$

Combined PEC Score (40) x 2.5 = Points Awarded (100)

SEC. 5.04 EXPERIENCE AND QUALIFICATIONS

This portion of the offeror's proposal will be evaluated based on the information required in Sec. 3.04 Transition Requirements of this RFP and the level of experience it demonstrates.

The State will evaluate the proposed staffing model, skill levels, labor categories, allocation, and relevant work experience demonstrated by Key Personnel including the following:

- Experience in performing work of similar scope and complexity
- Experience with similar technology, software development and related development methodology, human-centered design, and continuous deployment methods

SEC. 5.05 TECHNICAL UNDERSTANDING AND APPROACH

The State will evaluate the offeror's technical approach, focusing on the level of knowledge, technical expertise, and overall understanding of the requirements. The State will also consider the offeror's skills with similar technology, software development, and continuous deployment methods. Of special note is how well the proposed approach aligns with the Department's Technical Strategy.

Key points to include:

- Technical Expertise and Knowledge:
  - Experience with similar projects: describe previous projects that are similar in scope and complexity to the current RFP. Highlight specific technologies, methodologies, and tools used
  - Understanding of project requirements: demonstrate a thorough understanding of the project requirements outlined in Section 3.01 and Section 3.04. Explain how your team's expertise aligns with these requirements
- Proposed Plans:
  - Adherence to technical requirements: provide a plan on how you will adhere to the technical requirements and standards listed in Attachment 2
  - Implementation Strategy: outline your approach to implementing the project, including key milestones, timelines, and deliverables. Describe the processes and practices that will be used to ensure successful project execution
- Technical Risks and Opportunities:
  - Risk identification and mitigation: identify potential technical risks associated with the project and provide strategies for mitigating these risks. Discuss how you will proactively address challenges to ensure project success

  - Opportunities for Innovation: highlight any opportunities for innovation within the project. Explain how your team plans to leverage new technologies, methodologies, or practices to enhance project outcomes
- Collaboration and Communication:
  - Team coordination: describe how your team will coordinate and communicate effectively throughout the project. Include details on team structure, roles, and responsibilities
  - Stakeholder engagement: explain how you will engage with stakeholders to ensure their needs and expectations are met. Discuss your approach to managing stakeholder relationships and communication
- Quality Assurance and Testing:
  - Quality assurance management strategy: provide an overview of your quality assurance management strategy, including methods for ensuring the quality and reliability of deliverables. Describe how you will monitor and evaluate project performance
  - Testing strategy: detail your testing strategy, including types of tests to be conducted, testing environments, and methodologies. Explain how you will ensure comprehensive test coverage and defect management
- Documentation and Reporting:
  - System documentation: outline your approach to creating and maintaining system documentation. Include details on the types of documentation to be produced and how it will be kept up to date

SEC. 5.06 PRODUCT MANAGEMENT APPROACH

The State will evaluate the offeror's approach to project coordination, risk management, issue management, user testing, and research coordination.

SEC. 5.07 CONTRACT COST (COST PROPOSAL)

Overall, a minimum of 25% of the total evaluation points will be assigned to cost. The offeror with the lowest total cost will receive the maximum number of points allocated to cost per 2 AAC 12.260(c). The point allocations for cost on the other proposals will be determined using the following formula:

[(Price of Lowest Cost Proposal) x (Maximum Points for Cost)] ÷ (Cost of Each Higher Priced Proposal)

Example (Max Points for Contract Cost = 400):

Step 1
List all proposal prices, adjusted where appropriate by the application of applicable preferences claimed by the offeror.

Offeror #1	$40,000
Offeror #2	$42,750
Offeror #3	$47,500

Step 2

In this example, the RFP allotted 25% of the available 1,000 points to cost. This means that the lowest cost will receive the maximum number of points.

Offeror #1 receives 250 points.

The reason they receive that amount is because the lowest cost proposal, in this case $40,000, receives the maximum number of points allocated to cost, **250** points.

Offeror #2 receives 233.9 points.

$40,000 lowest cost x 250 maximum points for cost = 10,000,000 ÷ $42,750 cost of Offeror #2's proposal = ***233.9***

Offeror #3 receives 210.5 points.

$40,000 lowest cost x 400 maximum points for cost = 10,000,000 ÷ $47,500 cost of Offeror #3's proposal = **210.5**

SEC. 5.08 SHORTLISTING

After proposals have been prioritized, the state may shortlist and interview the top three highest ranking offerors. The state may increase or decrease the number of offerors in this list based on the competitiveness of the proposals and/or from feedback from the PEC.

SEC. 5.09 INTERVIEWS OF CRITICAL TEAM MEMBERS

The state may conduct an interview with the proposed key personnel along with the critical team members identified in Submittal Form A of the offeror's proposal (the state reserves the right to request additional personnel). All these personnel must attend the interview, and no other individuals from the offeror's organization will be allowed to sit in or participate during the interview sessions. If any of these personnel fail to attend the interview the offeror may be given a "1" score, which may jeopardize the offeror's competitiveness.

Interviews are expected to last approximately 90 minutes, but that time may be increased or decreased at the discretion of the state. Interviewees may not bring notes, presentation materials, or handouts. Interviewees may be prohibited from making any reference to their proposed cost/fees.

Below is an example of the schedule the interviews will follow:

No.	Agenda Item	Time Allocated
1	Introductions	Approximately 5 minutes
2	Open Session	80 minutes
3	Closing Remarks	5 minutes

Introductions will be used solely to introduce team member's names and roles on both the State and the offeror's teams. Time for introductions will not be allocated to business development purposes.

During the open technical session, the offeror will respond to the State's questions regarding the technical aspects of their proposal. A demonstration of code management processes, where multiple teams work on a single code base including tools, testing, and process control, is particularly valuable.

Demonstrations

A brief demonstration of a similar application/database built on comparable technology is permitted, or a proposed COTS, or SaaS product. If a production application/database is not available for demo, a working prototype may be presented.

The goal of this session is to assess the abilities and understanding of the proposed Key Personnel and to further elaborate on the proposed approach described in the written proposal.

The State is not interested in a demo or overview of an eligibility system that does not share similar technology and does not demonstrate the team's ability to modify and maintain the State of Alaska's Integrated Eligibility Platform. Currently, the State of Alaska is not interested in a full system replacement and does not intend to issue an RFP to do so.

The proposed Key Personnel must participate in the verbal presentation. Otherwise, the offeror will be considered non-responsive and excluded from further consideration. The State is most interested in hearing from staff who will have a direct role in completing the tasks.

Verbal presentations will take place via Microsoft Teams video chat. The State will coordinate and set up the meeting accordingly. We strongly encourage you to join with audio, video, and screen sharing capability.

The open session will not exceed 90 minutes. The Procurement Officer will strictly enforce this time limit on all presentations.

There will be no follow-up session for further questions after the presentation.

Interviewees may be asked questions regarding their experience, knowledge and understanding of the scope of work, obstacles and challenges, strategies, and their plan/approach. The state may request additional information prior to interviews. The PEC will score each interview individually using the 1, 5, 10 scoring method described in Sec. 5.03 Scoring Method and Calculation and may have a group discussion prior to finalizing scores.

SEC. 5.10 COST REASONABLENESS

Prior to entering into contract negotiations, the procurement officer may perform a 'cost reasonable' assessment of all shortlisted proposals in the following manner:

- If the highest ranked offeror's cost proposal is within 5% of the next highest ranked offeror's cost proposal, the state will proceed to invite the highest ranked offeror to contract negotiations.
- If the highest ranked offeror's cost proposal is 5% or more (higher) than the next highest ranked offeror's cost proposal, the state reserves the right to invite the second highest ranked offeror to contract negotiations.

SEC. 5.11 CONTRACT NEGOTIATIONS

After final evaluation, the procurement officer may negotiate with the offeror of the highest-ranked proposal. Negotiations, if held, shall be within the scope of the request for proposals and limited to those items which would not have an effect on the ranking of proposals.

If the selected offeror:

- fails to provide the information required to begin negotiations in a timely manner; or

- fails to negotiate in good faith; or
- indicates they cannot perform the contract within the budgeted funds available for the project; or
- if the offeror and the state, after a good faith effort, simply cannot come to terms, the State may terminate negotiations with the offeror initially selected and commence negotiations with the next highest ranked offeror.

SEC. 5.12 OFFEROR NOTIFICATION OF SELECTION

After the completion of contract negotiation, the procurement officer will issue a written Notice of Intent to Award and send copies of that notice to all offerors who submitted proposals. The notice will list the names of all offerors and identify the offeror selected for the award.

SECTION 6. GENERAL PROCESS AND LEGAL INFORMATION

SEC. 6.01 STANDARD CONTRACT PROVISIONS

The contractor will be required to sign the state's Standard Agreement Form for Professional Services. This form is Attachment 04 and attached with the RFP for your review. The contractor must comply with the Appendix A contract provisions set out in this attachment. No alteration of these provisions will be permitted without prior written approval from the Department of Law, and the state reserves the right to reject a proposal that is non-compliant or takes exception with the contract terms and conditions stated in the Agreement. Any requests to change language in this document (adjust, modify, add, delete, etc.), must be set out in the offeror's proposal in a separate document. Please include the following information with any change that is proposed:

1) Identify the provision that the offeror takes exception with.
2) Identify why the provision is unjust, unreasonable, etc.
3) Identify exactly what suggested changes should be made.

SEC. 6.02 BUSINESS ASSOCIATE AGREEMENT (BAA)

The State has a standard BAA that is included in IT-related contracts that involve Personal Health Information (PHI) covered under the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability (HIPAA) Act. This BAA will be included in the fully executed contract and is attached along with this RFP as HIPAA BAA. Any request to change language in Section 1 of this document must be set out in the offeror's proposal in a separate document. Any changes must be approved by the DOH Security Office and the Department of Law.

To further ensure the State meets its legal obligations regarding Protected Health Information and other confidential information, the BAA contains another section (Section 2) titled Department of Health HIPAA and HITECH Information Security Agreement (ISA). Note that ISA section is non-negotiable and if there is any conflict between the ISA section and the BAA section, the ISA prevails. Agreement with the ISA provisions is also required in order for the contractor pass the security assessment process indicated in Section 3.04.

SEC. 6.03 QUALIFIED OFFERORS

Per 2 AAC 12.875, unless provided for otherwise in the RFP, to qualify as an offeror for award of a contract issued under AS 36.30, the offeror must:

1) Add value in the contract by actually performing, controlling, managing, or supervising the services to be provided; or
2) Be in the business of selling and have actually sold on a regular basis the supplies that are the subject of the RFP

If the offeror leases services or supplies or acts as a broker or agency in providing the services or supplies in order to meet these requirements, the procurement officer may not accept the offeror as a qualified offeror under AS 36.30.

SEC. 6.04 PROPOSAL AS PART OF THE CONTRACT

Part of all of this RFP and the successful proposal may be incorporated into the contract.

SEC. 6.05 ADDITIONAL TERMS AND CONDITIONS

The state reserves the right to add terms and conditions during contract negotiations. These terms and conditions will be within the scope of the RFP and will not affect the proposal evaluations.

SEC. 6.06 HUMAN TRAFFICKING

By signature on their proposal, the offeror certifies that the offeror is not established and headquartered or incorporated and headquartered in a country recognized as Tier 3 in the most recent United States Department of State's Trafficking in Persons Report.

The most recent United States Department of State's Trafficking in Persons Report can be found at the following website.

Failure to comply with this requirement will cause the state to reject the proposal as non-responsive or cancel the contract.

SEC. 6.07 RIGHT OF REJECTION

Offerors must comply with all of the terms of the RFP, the State Procurement Code (AS 36.30), and all applicable local, state, and federal laws, codes, and regulations. The procurement officer may reject any proposal that does not comply with all of the material and substantial terms, conditions, and performance requirements of the RFP.

Offerors may not qualify the proposal nor restrict the rights of the state. If an offeror does so, the procurement officer may determine the proposal to be a non-responsive counteroffer, and the proposal may be rejected.

Minor informalities that:

- do not affect responsiveness
- are merely a matter of form or format
- do not change the relative standing or otherwise prejudice other offers
- do not change the meaning or scope of the RFP
- are trivial, negligible, or immaterial in nature
- do not reflect a material change in the work
- do not constitute a substantial reservation against a requirement or provision may be waived by the procurement officer

The state reserves the right to refrain from making an award if it determines that to be in its best interest. A proposal from a debarred or suspended offeror shall be rejected.

SEC. 6.08 STATE NOT RESPONSIBLE FOR PREPARATION COSTS

The state will not pay any cost associated with the preparation, submittal, presentation, or evaluation of any proposal.

SEC. 6.09 DISCLOSURE OF PROPOSAL CONTENTS

This section governs the ownership, return, and disclosure of any offer or other record an offeror submits in response to this request for proposals. (Herein, any reference to "Record" includes all such records and the offer; any reference to "Law" includes any federal or State of Alaska (State) law, including any court or administrative order or rule.)

1. All Records belong to the state.
2. The state has sole discretion regarding whether to return any Record. In exercising this discretion, the state will comply with all Laws.
3. Unless a notice of intent to award is issued, the state will, to the extent permitted by Law, consider all Records confidential and not subject to the Alaska Public Records Act (APRA).
4. If and when a notice of intent to award is issued, the state will consider nonconfidential any Record unless, at the time of submission, the offeror undertook the following protective measures in their proposal (considering page limits in Section 4.02 of the RFP, the offeror may set out in a separate document):
    a. marked information confidential;
    b. for any information marked confidential, identified the authority that makes that specific information confidential; and
    c. committed, in writing, to explain in detail, including with affidavits and briefs, why each authority applies in any court or administrative proceeding in which any nondisclosure is challenged.
5. If the offeror did not undertake each protective measure, the state will not consider any information in a Record confidential: the state will disclose the entire Record without any redaction in response to an APRA or other request or, if it chooses, in the absence of a request and the state will disclose the entire Record without notifying the offeror.
6. If the offeror undertook each protective measure, the state will withhold the information marked confidential to the following extent:
    a. the state agrees that the Law protects the information; and
    b. if the nondisclosure is challenged, the offeror fulfills its commitment to explain, including with affidavits and briefs, how each authority applies to the information marked confidential.
7. The state will only notify an offeror of a request for the Record and of a planned release if the offeror undertook each protective measure, but the state disagrees that the marked information is protected. If there is such a disagreement, then before releasing the Record, the state will, to the extent permitted by Law and practicable, notify the offeror that it will disclose the information unless the offeror convinces the state not to or obtains an order prohibiting disclosure.

SEC. 6.10 ASSIGNMENT

Per 2 AAC 12.480, the contractor may not transfer or assign any portion of the contract without prior written approval from the procurement officer.

SEC. 6.11 SEVERABILITY

If any provision of the contract or agreement is declared by a court to be illegal or in conflict with any law, the validity of the remaining terms and provisions will not be affected; and the rights and obligations of the parties will be construed and enforced as if the contract did not contain the particular provision held to be invalid.

SEC. 6.12 SUPPLEMENTAL TERMS AND CONDITIONS

Proposals must comply with Sec. 6.07 Right of Rejection. However, if the state fails to identify or detect supplemental terms or conditions that conflict with those contained in this RFP or that diminish the state's rights

under any contract resulting from the RFP, the term(s) or condition(s) will be considered null and void. After the award of the contract:

If conflict arises between a supplemental term or condition included in the proposal and a term or condition of the RFP, the term or condition of the RFP will prevail; and

If the state's rights would be diminished as a result of application of a supplemental term or condition included in the proposal, the supplemental term or condition will be considered null and void.

SEC. 6.13 SOLICITATION ADVERTISING

Public notice has been provided in accordance with 2 AAC 12.220.

SEC. 6.14 CLARIFICATION OF OFFERS

Prior to the contract negotiation period detailed in RFP Sec. 5.11 Contract Negotiations, to determine if a proposal is reasonably susceptible for award, communications by the procurement officer or the proposal evaluation committee (PEC) are permitted with an offeror to clarify uncertainties or eliminate confusion concerning the contents of a proposal. Clarifications may not result in a material or substantive change to the proposal. The evaluation by the procurement officer or the PEC may be adjusted as a result of a clarification under this section.

SEC. 6.15 DISCUSSIONS WITH OFFERORS

Prior to the contract negotiation period detailed in RFP Sec. 5.11 Contract Negotiations, the state may conduct discussions with offerors in accordance with AS 36.30.240 and 2 AAC 12.290. The purpose of these discussions will be to ensure full understanding of the requirements of the RFP and proposal. Discussions will be limited to specific sections of the RFP or proposal identified by the procurement officer. Discussions will only be held with offerors who have submitted a proposal deemed reasonably susceptible for the contract award by the procurement officer. Discussions, if held, will be after the initial evaluation of proposals by the procurement officer or the PEC. If modifications are made as a result of these discussions they will be put in writing. Following discussions, the procurement officer may set a time for best and final proposal submissions from those offerors with whom discussions were held. Proposals may be reevaluated after receipt of best and final proposal submissions.

If an offeror does not submit a best and final proposal or a notice of withdrawal, the offeror’s immediate previous proposal is considered the offeror’s best and final proposal.

Offerors with a disability needing accommodation should contact the procurement officer prior to the date set for discussions so that reasonable accommodation can be made. Any oral modification of a proposal must be reduced to writing by the offeror.

SEC. 6.16 FEDERALLY IMPOSED TARIFFS

Changes in price (increase or decrease) resulting directly from a new or updated federal tariff, excise tax, or duty, imposed after contract award may be adjusted during the contract period or before delivery into the United States via contract amendment.

- Notification of Changes: The contractor must promptly notify the procurement officer in writing of any new, increased, or decreased federal excise tax or duty that may result in either an increase or decrease in the contact price and shall take appropriate action as directed by the procurement officer.

- After-imposed or Increased Taxes and Duties: Any federal excise tax or duty for goods or services covered by this contract that was exempted or excluded on the contract award date but later imposed on the contractor during the contract period, as the result of legislative, judicial, or administrative action may result in a price increase provided:
  a) The tax or duty takes effect after the contract award date and isn't otherwise addressed by the contract
  b) The contractor warrants, in writing, that no amount of the newly imposed federal excise tax or duty or rate increase was included in the contract price, as a contingency or otherwise
- After-relieved or Decreased Taxes and Duties: The contract price shall be decreased by the amount of any decrease in federal excise tax or duty for goods or services under the contract, except social security or other employment taxes, that the contractor is required to pay or bear, or does not obtain a refund of, through the contractor's fault, negligence, or failure to follow instructions of the procurement officer
- State's Ability to Make Changes: The state reserves the right to request verification of federal excise tax or duty amounts on goods or services covered by this contract and increase or decrease the contract price accordingly
- Price Change Threshold: No adjustment shall be made to the contract price under this clause unless the amount of the adjustment exceeds $250

SEC. 6.17 PROTEST

AS 36.30.560 provides that an interested party may protest the content of the RFP.

An interested party is defined in 2 AAC 12.990(a) (7) as "an actual or prospective bidder or offeror whose economic interest might be affected substantially and directly by the issuance of a contract solicitation, the award of a contract, or the failure to award a contract."

If an interested party wishes to protest the content of a solicitation, the protest must be received, in writing, by the procurement officer at least ten days prior to the deadline for receipt of proposals.

AS 36.30.560 also provides that an interested party may protest the award of a contract or the proposed award of a contract.

If an offeror wishes to protest the award of a contract or the proposed award of a contract, the protest must be received, in writing, by the procurement officer within ten days after the date the Notice of Intent to Award the contract is issued.

A protester must have submitted a proposal in order to have sufficient standing to protest the proposed award of a contract. Protests must include the following information:

- the name, address, and telephone number of the protester
- the signature of the protester or the protester's representative
- identification of the contracting agency and the solicitation or contract at issue
- a detailed statement of the legal and factual grounds of the protest including copies of relevant documents; and the form of relief requested

Protests filed by telex or telegram are not acceptable because they do not contain a signature. Fax copies containing a signature are acceptable.

The procurement officer will issue a written response to the protest. The response will set out the procurement officer's decision and contain the basis of the decision within the statutory time limit in AS 36.30.580. A copy of the decision will be furnished to the protester by certified mail, fax or another method that provides evidence of receipt.

All offerors will be notified of any protest. The review of protests, decisions of the procurement officer, appeals, and hearings, will be conducted in accordance with the State Procurement Code (AS 36.30), Article 8 "Legal and Contractual Remedies."

SECTION 7. ATTACHMENTS:

Sec. 7.01 Attachment 1 -- Submittal Forms A - F

Submittal Forms A - F can be found in this repository at Attachment 1 - Submittal Forms A - F

Sec. 7.02 Attachment 2 -- DOH IT Contractual Requirements

The DOH Contractual Requirements can be found in this repository at Attachment 2 - DOH Contractual Requirements - SAAS Solutions)

Sec. 7.03 Attachment 3 -- Submittal Form H - Cost Proposal

The Cost Proposal Form can be found in this repository at Attachment 3 - Submittal Form I - Cost Propsal

Sec. 7.04 Attachment 4 -- Standard Agreement Form

The Standard Agreement Form (with Appendices) can be found in this repository at Attachment 4 - Standard Agreement Form - Appendix A - F

Sec. 7.05 Attachment 5 -- Federal Regulations

The Federal Regulations can be found in this repository at Attachment 5 - Federal Regulations

Sec. 7.06 Attachment 6 -- Non-Disclosure Agreement and Intent to Propose

The Non-Disclosure Agreement and Intent to Propose can be found in this repository at Attachment 6 - NDA-Non-Disclosure Agreement and Intent to Propose

Sec. 7.07 Attachment 7 -- Quality Assurance Plan (QAP) and Service Level Agreement (SLA)

The Quality Assurance Plan and Service Level Agreement can be found in this repository at Attachment 7 - Quality Assurance Plan (QAP) and Service Level Agreement (SLA)

Sec. 7.08 Attachment 8 -- CMS Required Outcomes

The CMS Required Outcomes can be found in this repository at [Attachment 8 - CMS Required Outcomes](https://github.com/akhealth/RFP-IEP-Milestone2.5/blob/main/08%20CMS%20Required%20Outcomes.pdf

Sec. 7.09 Attachment 9 -- BAA

The BAA can be found in this repository at Attachment 9 - CMS Required Outcomes